

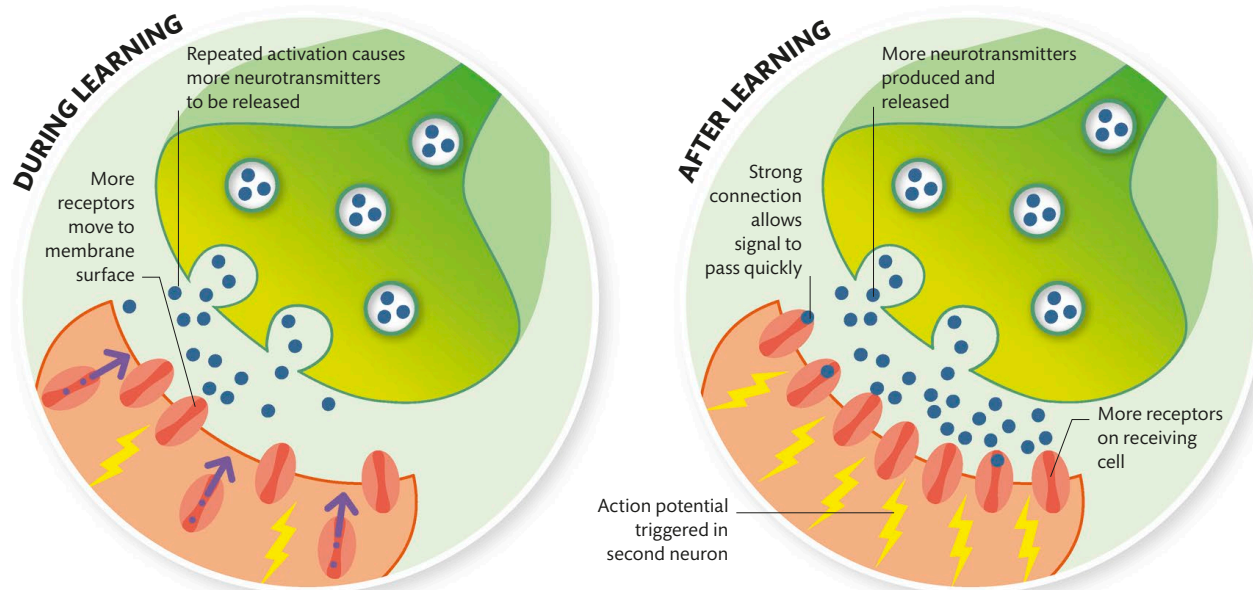
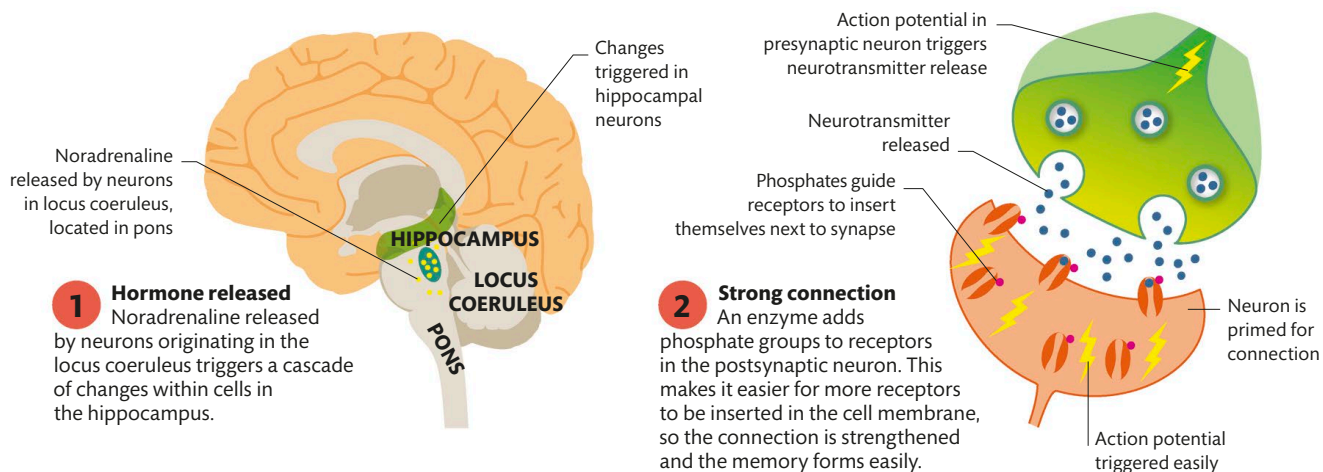


Emotional memories

When something strongly emotional happens, whether that is good or bad, stress chemicals such as adrenaline and noradrenaline are released. These make it easier for long-term potentiation to occur with fewer repetitions. This explains why emotionally arousing memories are stored more rapidly in the brain and why they are easier to recall than nonemotional memories.

KEY

- Neurotransmitter
- Phosphate



- 2** Both neurons firing repeatedly at the same time causes a chemical cascade within the second cell (see p.26), which makes it more sensitive to the neurotransmitter, and causes extra receptors to migrate to the edge of the synapse. A signal travels back to the first cell, telling it to produce more neurotransmitters.
- 3** Now, a single action potential causes the release of more neurotransmitters, carrying the message quickly and efficiently across the synapse, where it is received by many receptors. This makes it easier for the second neuron to be activated, sending its electrical signal onward.